

GETTING THE MOST FROM YOUR TEA

Each type of tea has a distinct character, and displays a flavor, color, and aroma that is decidedly its own. The following guidelines will help you experience the full flavor potential of the teas, but as enjoyment is paramount, feel free to adapt the guidelines to your taste.

GREEN TEA

At its best, green tea will bring a freshness reminiscent of open meadows or sea air. Start with a leaf less than one year old, and pay attention to water temperature: too much heat will kill the gentle amino acids that sweeten the tea, while water that is too cool will prevent the flavor from developing fully.

Steeping time is very important for green teas. As an oversteeped tea can be astringent and bitter, it is best to start with a short steep, taste it, and increase the steeping time by 30 seconds, until it suits your palate.

DRY LEAVES

Green tea leaves may be light or dark green, and come in many shapes and sizes, from thin, twisted, and dusty as in this example, to flat, shiny, and bud-like.



WET LEAVES

During infusion, the tea unravels to reveal buds and leaves.



PREPARATION GUIDELINES

Tea shown here: Bi Luo Chun (Green Snail Springtime), from Dong Ting mountain, Jiangsu province, China

Measure: 1 tbsp for $\frac{3}{4}$ cup water

Water temperature: 170°F (75°C) for Chinese teas; 150°F (65°C) for Japanese teas. Use spring water, if possible.

Infusion: Test with a short steep, and increase steeping time by 30 seconds for each infusion. Can be used for 3-4 infusions.



LIQUOR

The infused and strained tea, also known as liquor, is pale green, with a hint of yellow. The brew is fresh and bright, with soft, fruity flavors.